

DESIGN SYSTEM · V1.1

The uxproof application design system

The single visual and interaction reference for the uxproof web application — the chat surface, the files and presentations views, and every dialog around them. Every token in this document was read out of the running implementation, not invented for it. v1.1 folds the v1.0 findings back into the code.



SCOPE

The web app in `next/`. The generated PowerPoint deck is a separate system — see `lib/branding/brand.ts`.

DERIVED FROM

`app/globals.css`, `components/ui/*`, and all 26 product components.

TYPE

Schibsted Grotesk (display & body)
IBM Plex Mono (chrome & numbers)

ISSUED

2026-08-20 · v1.1
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CONTENTS

02	Design language — what makes this UI recognisable
03	Colour — light theme
04	Colour — dark theme, status hues, measured contrast
05	Typography
06	Spacing, grid & layout
07	Radius, borders, elevation, motion
08	Components — actions
09	Components — forms & identity
10	Components — containers & overlays
11	Patterns — application chrome
12	Patterns — the conversation
13	Patterns — collections, states, destructive flows
14	Interaction & UX rules
15	Accessibility
16	Token reference · conflicts & canonical decisions

THE ONE RULE THAT OUTRANKS THE REST

There are two violets in this repository and they must never meet. The application's identity is `#5B47D6` (light) / `#7060e0` (dark), defined in `app/globals.css`. The generated deck's violet is `#6D4AF5`, defined in `lib/branding/brand.ts`. They are separate systems with separate grounds, separate radii and separate rules. This document governs the first one only.

The single sanctioned crossing is the slide-thumbnail strip in `presentation-preview.tsx`, which paints deck ground `#F3F2F2` and deck violet `#6D4AF5` because it is *depicting* the deck. Nothing else in the app may reference a deck token.

DESIGN LANGUAGE

A quiet tool that gets loud only where evidence needs pointing at.

uxproof is a working instrument, not a marketing surface. The chrome recedes; the research content is the only thing with weight.

Violet is the only chroma, and it is rationed

Neutrals are violet-tinted rather than grey — surfaces are `#f8f7fc`, borders are `rgba(91, 71, 214, .10)` — so the accent feels native rather than applied. Saturated violet marks exactly three things: the primary action, the active state, and work in progress.

Flat by default, elevated only when detached

Surfaces separate by tint and a hairline, not by shadow. Shadows appear only on things that genuinely float: dropdowns, popovers, toasts, the open history drawer.

Compact density, generous page rhythm

Controls are small (32 px default button, 32 px input) and gaps inside a row are tight (6–12 px), but sections are separated by 24–32 px and page gutters are 24 px. Dense where you work, open where you read.

Text carries the hierarchy; boxes rarely do

One display headline per view at `text-3xl` with `-0.04em` tracking, a muted one-line subtitle, then content. Card titles are `font-medium`, not bold. Nothing shouts twice.

Motion narrates, it never decorates

Every animation reports state: the step ladder advancing, a toast counting down its own lifetime, a view fading in from a 4 px blur. All of it is suppressed under `prefers-reduced-motion`.

The interface is honest about what it knows

Every number shown came from an uploaded file. Empty states say *upload something* rather than showing a plausible demo; deletions name exactly what leaves. The visual language serves that: no filler cards, no padded grids, no invented data.

Every value below is a CSS custom property on `:root` in `app/globals.css`, exposed to Tailwind through `@theme inline`. Address colour by token — `bg-card`, `text-muted-foreground` — never by hex.

GROUND & SURFACES

background
#ffffff
The page. Pure white here, unlike the deck, which is never white.

card
#f8f7fc
Every raised container: file rows, stat cards, deck cards, the login form.

muted
#ececfc
Recessed fills — ghost-button hover, avatar fallback, code, table head. Usually at 30-60% alpha.

accent
#ede9fc
Reserved tint one step warmer than muted. Barely used — do not reach for it casually.

INK

foreground
#09090b
All primary text and icons. Also the tooltip's ground (inverted).

muted-foreground
#696979
Subtitles, metadata, timestamps, placeholders. The palette's contrast floor — never lighten it.

secondary-foreground
#030213
Ink on secondary fills only.

— user bubble
#23233d / 90%
The one hard-coded surface: the user's own chat bubble. Inverts to #fafafa in dark.

ACTION & ACCENT

primary · ring
#5b47d6
The one filled action per view, the active nav item, focus ring, progress fill.

secondary
#f0effe
Low-emphasis filled control and the neutral badge (period chips, attachments).

violet-600 (scale)
#7c3aed
Accent ink: inline action icons, the Sparkles on an AI action, citation chips. Pairs with `violet-400` in dark. The “ux” in the wordmark is *not* this — it is the logomark violet.

logomark violet
#7e27fe
The app tile and favicon — a flat violet, one step warmer than `primary`, and the identity's own colour rather than a UI token. Kept in sync across `UxproofMark`, `app/icon.svg` and the deck cover mark.

LINE, FOCUS & ALARM

border
rgba(91,71,214,.10)
Every hairline. Violet at 10% — a tinted line, never a grey one.

destructive/10 (wash)
rgba(212,24,61,.10)
The danger wash: delete-button hover, the confirm dialog's icon tile, error blocks. Ink stays full strength on top.

destructive
#d4183d
The only danger colour. Validation, errors, deletion and the one solid confirm button. Raw `red-*` and `rose-*` are banned.

ring (focus, 50%)
#5b47d6 @ 50%
The 3px focus halo, identical on every control in the product. Never removed, never restyled.

DARK THEME

Applied by a `.dark` class on `<html>` (`theme-provider.tsx`), persisted to `localStorage['uxproof-theme']`. Default is `light`; the OS preference is consulted only when nothing is stored. Dark is not an inversion — it is a navy-violet night palette with its own, lighter primary.

background
#13131f

card · popover
#171726

muted · secondary · input
#21213a

accent
#23233d

primary · ring
#7060e0

foreground
#eeeef5

muted-foreground
#9090b0

— darkest ground
#0f0f1c

Borders in dark are `rgba(120,100,220,.13)`. The accent ink shifts one step lighter across the board: `violet-600` → `violet-400`, `emerald-600` → `emerald-400`. **--destructive inverts rather than darkens** — `#f87171` (6.66:1) with `--destructive-foreground: #13131f` on top of it, because dark mode needs danger to read as ink against the ground. Every accent utility is written as a light dark: pair — keep it that way.

MEASURED CONTRAST

Computed from the shipped token values (WCAG 2.1 relative luminance). This is a measurement of the current palette, not a compliance claim — the product has not been formally audited.

PAIR	RATIO	AA BODY
foreground on background (light)	19.90:1	pass
foreground on background (dark)	15.94:1	pass
primary-foreground on primary (light)	6.33:1	pass
primary-foreground on primary (dark)	4.73:1	pass
muted-foreground on background (light)	5.39:1	pass
muted-foreground on card (light)	5.06:1	pass
muted-foreground on muted (light)	4.62:1	pass
muted-foreground on background (dark)	5.96:1	pass
violet-600 / violet-400 accent ink	5.70 / 6.77:1	pass
destructive on background (light / dark)	5.25 / 6.66:1	pass
destructive on card (light / dark)	4.93 / 6.40:1	pass
destructive-foreground on destructive (light / dark)	5.25 / 6.66:1	pass
emerald-600 on background (light) — icon only	3.77:1	graphics
amber-600 on background (light) — icon only	3.19:1	graphics

RULES THAT FOLLOW FROM THE MEASUREMENTS

- 1 · Every text pair clears AA in both themes, and it is meant to stay that way. Two values moved in v1.1: `--muted-foreground` darkened from `#717182` (4.49:1 on card), and the dark `--destructive` pair — 2.66:1, which made form errors almost invisible — was inverted.
- 2 · Emerald and amber are icon-only in light mode. At 3.77:1 and 3.19:1 they clear the 3:1 bar for graphics but not the 4.5:1 bar for text. Every use is a dot, a check glyph or a 14-16px icon — if a label must read as successful, use `foreground` and let the icon carry the hue.
- 3 · Muted text on a card is the floor (5.06:1), and it is where most muted text lands. Never introduce a lighter muted, and never put muted text on muted (4.62:1 is already the tightest pairing the system allows).

STATUS HUES

MEANING	LIGHT / DARK	WHERE IT IS ALLOWED
Success	emerald-600 / emerald-400	Completed pipeline steps, success toasts, the “Ready” badge on a built deck. Never a fill larger than a 16 px dot or a 10% wash.
In progress	violet-500 / violet-400	Running steps, the streaming caret, the spinner in a generating card. Progress is violet because progress is the product.
Danger	destructive	Everything that fails or destroys: validation, error toasts, error bubbles, delete icons, the confirm button. One token, one hue, both themes.
Advisory	amber-600 / amber-400	Quick-action icons for comparison and analysis. Not a warning colour — this product has no warning state — and never on text, at 3.19:1.

FAMILIES

Schibsted Grotesk

--font-sans --font-heading — loaded through next/font/google as --font-schibsted. Fallback: "Helvetica Neue", sans-serif.
Carries display, headings, body, labels and buttons. There is no second text face.

Regular 400 · Medium 500 · Semibold 600 · Bold 700

600 is the ceiling in practice. font-bold appears nowhere in the app — use font-semibold, or the .display role, when you want more weight.

IBM Plex Mono

--font-mono — weights 300 / 400 / 500 loaded. Strictly for machine facts and chrome: file extensions, quarter tags (Q3 2025), durations, countdown digits, citation chips, and uppercase group labels. Never for prose.

Q3 2025 2.4s THIS WEEK p.2

TRACKING & LEADING

ROLE	TRACKING	LEADING
Display / h1	-0.04em	1.05 – 1.2
h2	-0.02em	1.25
h3 / card title / markdown heading	-0.01em (tracking-tight)	1.375 – 1.5
Body & UI	0	1.5 – 1.625
Mono chrome label	0.10 – 0.18em	1

Negative tracking is what makes the headlines look like this product rather than a default Tailwind page. It belongs to display sizes only — never track body text tight.

ROLES

UX Evidence — Perfectly Presented

display · text-3xl — 30px / 600 / -0.04em / 1.05 · one per view, always the first thing on the page

Your profile

DialogTitle · text-2xl — 24px / 500 · panel titles only

Q3 2025 UX Research Report

CardTitle · text-base — 16px / 500 / font-heading · card and dialog headings

SUS rose 4.2 points quarter over quarter, driven almost entirely by the checkout flow. Task success held flat at 87%.

Body · text-sm — 14px / 400 / leading-relaxed · every message, paragraph and description

Display name

Label · text-sm / 500 / leading-none · sits 6px above its field

CSV · 48.2 KB · 3 days ago

Metadata · text-xs — 12px / muted-foreground · timestamps, counts, helper text

Aurelo · Q3 2025

Micro · text-[11px] · context tags and sidebar metadata

YESTERDAY

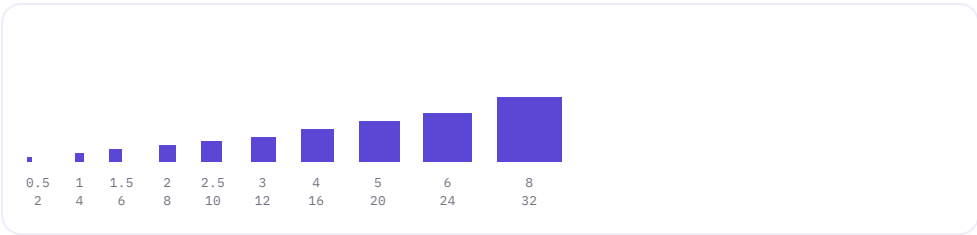
Chrome label · font-mono text-[10px] uppercase tracking-[0.15em] · group headers

SCALE IN USE

UTILITY	SIZE	WEIGHT	APPLIED TO
text-3xl	30px	600	Page headline (always with .display)
text-2xl	24px	500	Dialog / panel title
text-lg	18px	600	Markdown h1 inside a message
text-base	16px	500	Card title, markdown h2
text-sm	14px	400 / 500	Body, buttons, inputs, labels — the workhorse
text-xs	12px	400 / 500	Metadata, badges, helper text, dense actions
text-[11px]	11px	400	Context tags, sidebar metadata, citation chips
text-[10px]	10px	400	Mono chrome labels, period chips, durations

Do not add sizes between these — eight steps cover the whole product.

SPACING SCALE — BASE UNIT 4PX



TOKEN	VALUE	CANONICAL USE
space.0.5-1	2-4px	Icon-to-glyph nudges, chip padding, gaps inside a badge
space.1.5-2	6-8px	Gap between a control and its icon; label → field; chip rows
space.2.5-3	10-12px	Horizontal padding inside buttons and fields; gap between sibling controls
space.4	16px	Container padding. Card, dialog, top-bar gutter, message-row gap
space.5	20px	Roomier card padding (stat cards, login form uses 24)
space.6	24px	Page gutter and the gap between message rows / deck cards
space.8	32px	Page top padding and the gap between major sections

The scale is Tailwind's, unmodified. What is systematic here is the *assignment*: 16 for anything with a border around it, 24 between siblings on a page, 32 between sections. When in doubt, pick from this table rather than inventing a value.

STACKING ORDER

Z-INDEX	LAYER
100	Toast stack — must survive every overlay
80 / 70	Dialog content / dialog overlay
50	Top bar · dropdown · select · tooltip
30 / 20	History drawer / its scrim
10	Fixed chat composer

FRAME



SURFACE	CONTENT WIDTH	GUTTER & RHYTHM
Chat / · /chat/[id]	max-w-3xl · 768	px-6 py-6 · space-y-6
Files /files	max-w-4xl · 896	px-6 py-8 · space-y-3
Presentations /presentations	max-w-7xl · 1280	px-6 py-8 · gap-6
Login	max-w-sm · 384	centred · space-y-5
Dialog / panel	max-w-sm-md	p-4 · px-6 in panels

COLUMNS & BREAKPOINTS

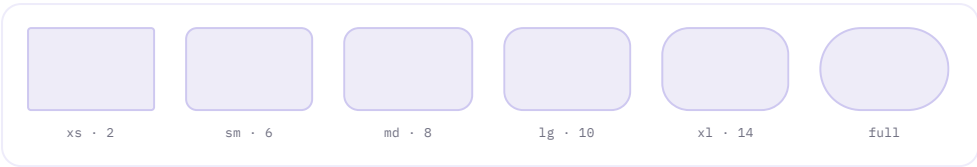
Tailwind defaults, and only three of them are actually used. The app is a desktop research tool; there is no mobile layout and none should be invented speculatively.

BP	MIN-W	WHAT CHANGES
sm	640px	Extracted-period chips appear on a file row; dialog footers become a row
md	768px	Deck grid 1 → 2 columns; inputs drop to 14px
lg	1024px	Deck grid 2 → 3 columns

Alignment. Everything is flush left. The only centred things in the product are the login card, the welcome state, empty states, and the composer's own quick-action row — each of them a moment with no content to align to yet.

Fixed dimensions to respect: top bar 56px; drawer 288px; content offset pt-14; drawer height calc(100% - 56px); toast column anchored top-16 right-4, directly under the avatar.

RADIUS — DERIVED FROM --RADIUS: 0.625REM



TOKEN	PX	APPLIED TO
radius.xs	2	The clipped corner of a chat bubble's tail — nothing else
radius.sm	6	Inline code, tooltip, small inline chips
radius.md	8	Dropdown items, icon tiles, pipeline rows, mode-switch tabs
radius.lg	10	Controls. Buttons, inputs, textarea, select trigger, popover surfaces, session rows
radius.xl	14	Containers. Cards, dialogs, panels, chat bubbles, toasts
radius.2xl	16	The login card only — one step softer than an in-app card
radius.full	pill	Badges, avatars, the composer pill, the send button, status dots

The rule to remember: radius grows with the size of the thing. Controls 10, containers 14, and identity elements are circles. The asymmetric bubble is the one deliberate exception — see page 11.

BORDERS

KIND	DEFINITION & USE
Hairline	1px solid var(--border) — the default separation between any two surfaces. There is no 2px border anywhere in the app.
Ring instead of border	ring-1 ring-foreground/10 on Card and DialogContent: a neutral hairline that does not consume layout space or inherit the violet tint.
Divider	Same hairline, drawn as border-t on a card footer or h-px bg-border as a spacer in a section header.
Focus	border-ring + ring-3 ring-ring/50 — a 3px violet halo. Non-negotiable, see page 14.
Invalid	aria-invalid – border-destructive + ring-3 ring-destructive/20.
Selected	bg-violet-500/10 + border-violet-500/40 — the active conversation row. Selection is a tint plus a tinted edge, never a heavier line.
Awaiting input	border-dashed — only on the avatar drop target, where nothing has been supplied yet.

ELEVATION

The app is flat on purpose. A shadow is a claim that something has detached from the page — if it has not detached, it does not get one.

e0 · flat

In-page cards, file rows, message bubbles. Hairline only.

e1 · shadow-sm

Stat cards, the login card, the selected mode-switch tab.

e2 · shadow-md

Dropdown and select surfaces — the only floating menus.

e3 · shadow-lg/10

Toasts, and the deck card on hover.

SPECIAL	VALUE
History drawer	4px 0 24px -4px rgba(0,0,0,.12) — directional, cast rightward onto the page
Dialog scrim	bg-black/10 + backdrop-blur-xs
Drawer scrim	bg-black/20 · dark:black/40 + backdrop-blur-[1px]

Never put a shadow on something that also has a visible border and sits in the page flow. Elevation and outline are alternative ways of saying the same thing; using both reads as a mistake.

MOTION

DURATION	EASING	WHERE
100ms	default	Dialog and select open/close
150–200ms	default / ease-out	Colour and opacity transitions on every control
200ms	cubic-bezier(.22,1,.36,1)	Route enter (opacity + 4px blur), toast in/out, follow-up chips
280–300ms	cubic-bezier(.22,1,.36,1)	Thinking-step entrance, history drawer slide
850ms	step-end, infinite	animate-blink — the streaming caret
1.2s	cubic-bezier(0,0,.2,1)	animate-ping-pulse — the active step halo

The signature easing is cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1) — a fast, decelerating settle. Use it for anything that enters. Exits reuse the entrance in reverse and stay under 200ms.

REDUCED MOTION IS A HARD REQUIREMENT

@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) in globals.css collapses every animation and transition to 0.01ms and disables smooth scrolling; <MotionConfig reducedMotion="user"> in app-shell.tsx covers framer-motion. Any new animation must be reachable by one of those two — never animate through an inline style or a JS timer that neither can suppress. Corollary: no animation may be the sole carrier of information. The step ladder also changes text colour and swaps its dot for a check; the toast also prints the seconds remaining as digits.

BUTTON

components/ui/button.tsx — a cva recipe of six variants and eight sizes, and the only interactive control in the product. **Anatomy:** optional 16px leading icon · label (text-sm/500) · optional trailing icon, in a 32px pill of radius.lg, 10px side padding.

VARIANTS

SPECIMEN	VARIANT	WHEN TO USE
Generate	default	One per view. The single action the view exists for.
Cancel	outline	Equal-weight alternatives: Cancel, Summarize, New chat, follow-ups.
Download	secondary	Actions floating over imagery, where an outline would disappear.
Files	ghost	Chrome: nav, icon buttons, row actions.
Delete	destructive	A destructive action <i>offered</i> — destructive/10 wash under destructive ink, never solid. Solid red is earned by the confirmation step, not offered before it.
Learn more	link	Inline in prose only.

STATES

OUTLINE	GHOST	PRIMARY	STATE
Cancel	Files	Generate	default
Cancel	Files	Generate	hover
Cancel	Files	Generate	focus-visible
Cancel	Files	Generate	active
Cancel	Files	Generate	disabled
Deleting...			loading

BUTTON SIZES

xs · 24

sm · 28

default · 32

lg · 36

+

icon · 32²

default (32px) is the standard. sm is for dense rows — file-row actions, top-bar nav, follow-up chips. xs exists but is unused in the product. Icon-only buttons are perfect squares at the same heights and must carry an aria-label.

APPLIED ACTION RULES

- Navigation is a button whose fill means “you are here”**

The top-bar items switch ghost → default on the active route rather than using an underline or a rail. It is the same component doing double duty as state.
- Destructive actions are ghost until confirmed**

A delete affordance is a ghost icon button that turns text-red-500 with a bg-red-500/10 wash on hover. The only solid red button in the product is the confirm inside ConfirmDialog — red fill is earned by the confirmation step, not offered before it.
- Row actions hide until the row is engaged**

Drawer rename and delete sit at opacity-0, revealed by group-hover and focus-within — a hover-only affordance is unreachable by keyboard.
- Icons are 16px, 14px in dense rows, and always paired with a label**

Lucide, stroke-width 2, inheriting currentColor. The exception is the accent-tinted leading icon on outline buttons (violet Sparkles, Plus) marking an AI action. Icon-only is allowed in chrome only, with a tooltip and an aria-label.

COMPOSITE ACTION SPECIMENS

FILE-ROW PAIR — OUTLINE (SECONDARY) THEN FILLED (PRIMARY)

✦ Summarize

Generate presentation

🗑

▼

Reading order left to right: alternative, primary, then the quiet destructive and disclosure controls pushed to the far right. Never place a delete next to a primary.

STATE SEMANTICS

focus-visible — a 3px ring/50 halo plus a violet border, identical on every variant and never removed. hover — every variant responds, the filled one at bg-primary/80; until v1.1 that rule was scoped to [a], so a real <button> never changed. active — down 1px, except on menu triggers. loading — spinner in place of the leading icon, a present-participle label (“Deleting...”), disabled. Fix the recipe, never the call site: the two per-call-site hover overrides that existed to paper over the gap were deleted with it.

UXPROOF DESIGN SYSTEM

COMPONENTS — ACTIONS

INPUT · TEXTAREA · LABEL

Email

you@example.com

default — transparent fill, hairline border

Email

kat@example.com

focus-visible — ring-3 ring-ring/50

Email

not-an-email

aria-invalid — destructive border + 20% ring

Email

you@example.com

disabled — 50% opacity, not-allowed

Password

.....

Password fields always ship the reveal toggle (PasswordInput, duplicated in login-screen.tsx and profile-dialog.tsx); a 24px ghost icon button inset right-2, with the field padded pr-10 to clear it. Typing a password you cannot see is the most common cause of a failed sign-in.

Message

Ask about your uploaded reports, or request a presentation...

Textarea uses field-sizing-content — it grows with what is typed, between min-h-16 and a caller-supplied max (120px in the composer).

ANATOMY	RULE
Height	32px (h-8) · textarea min 64px
Padding	px-2.5 py-1 · 10px horizontal
Radius	radius.lg · 10px
Fill	transparent (light) · input/30 (dark)
Type size	16px, dropping to 14px at md
Label gap	6px — space-y-1.5 around the pair
Field gap	20px — space-y-5 between fields in a form

The 16px – 14px step is deliberate: 16px is the threshold below which mobile browsers zoom on focus. Do not set a field to text-sm unconditionally. Inside panels, fields take bg-muted/30 so they read as recessed against the panel's own surface.

SELECT

Monochrome Research

▼

Monochrome Research

Modern Minimal

Executive Dark

Same 32px shell as Input, with a muted chevron. The surface floats at shadow-md + ring-1 and item-aligns to the trigger. Highlight is bg-muted, never violet — violet in a list would read as “selected”.

BADGE

completed

draft

Q3 2025

outline

failed

report.csv

✓ Ready

20px tall, pill, text-xs/500, 8px side padding (6px when it carries an icon). Badges are read-only status — they are never buttons. default (violet fill) is reserved for a completed deck; everything else is secondary. Anything machine-shaped inside a badge — a period, a file extension — switches to font-mono text-[10px].

AVATAR

KP

KP

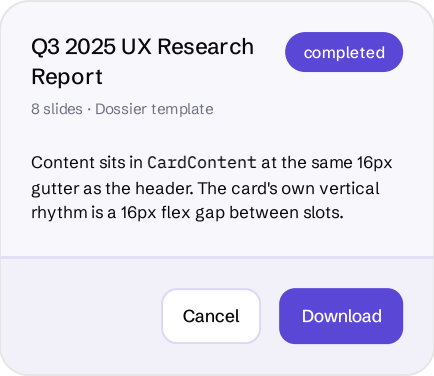
KP

24 / 32 / 40px, always circular, with a hairline drawn as a ::after ring in mix-blend-darken so it reads on any photo. The fallback is initials derived from the display name, or the email local-part — never a generic person glyph.

FORM BEHAVIOUR, PRODUCT-WIDE

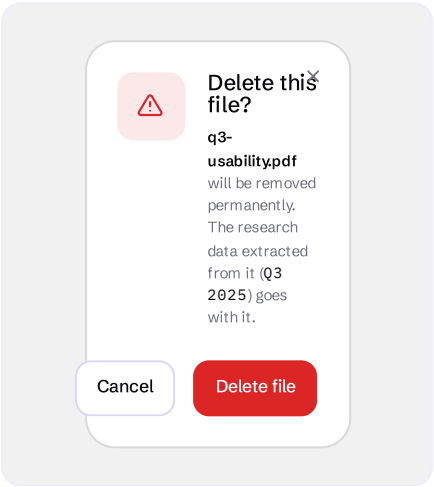
- **Validate on submit, not on keystroke.** Errors clear the moment the user edits the field again.
- **One error line per form,** role="alert", text-sm text-destructive, placed directly above the submit button. Fields are not individually annotated.
- **Client checks are a courtesy; the route is the authority.** The login screen says so in a comment and the server repeats every check.
- **Submit stays disabled until the form can succeed** — and, where the form edits existing values (Profile), until something has actually changed (profileDirty).
- **Every field has a real <Label htmlFor>** and a correct autoComplete. Placeholders are examples, never labels.

CARD



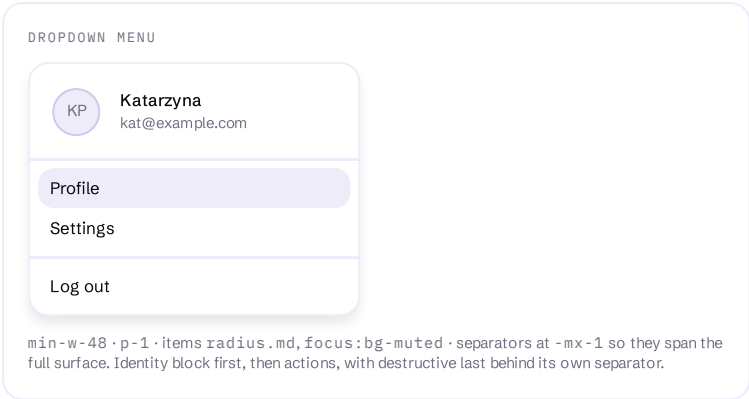
`radius.xl · bg-card · ring-1 ring-foreground/10` (a ring, not a border) `· py-4` with `px-4` per slot `· gap-4` between slots. Slots: `Header` (`Title` · `Description` · `Action`) → `Content` → `Footer`. The footer is the only tinted region and always sits flush to the card's edges. `size="sm"` tightens everything to 12px. Cards are flat — the hover shadow on a deck card is an affordance for a hover-revealed overlay, not decoration.

DIALOG



Two placements, and the choice is meaningful. `ConfirmDialog` is screen-centred because a permanent deletion should interrupt. `SettingsDialog` and `ProfileDialog` override the centring to `top-16 right-3` with `aslide-in-from-top-2`, so they hang from the avatar that opened them. Scrim is `bg-black/10` with `backdrop-blur-xs` — the app stays visible behind the decision. Escape and an outside click close, except while an action is pending.

OVERLAYS



TOAST



MINOR PRIMITIVES

COMPONENT	DEFINITION
Separator	<code>1px bg-border</code> , horizontal or vertical. The primitive is unused — the top bar hand-rolls <code>h-6 w-px bg-border</code> and menus use <code>DropdownMenuSeparator</code> . Prefer the primitive in new work
Progress	<code>h-1 pill track</code> on <code>bg-muted</code> , <code>bg-primary</code> indicator translated by percentage. Defined but unused — this product reports progress as a named step ladder, not a bar
ScrollArea	Radix wrapper used in the drawer and both panels; always paired with <code>flex-1 min-h-0</code>

REMOVED, AND WHY IT STAYS REMOVED

`tabs.tsx`, `accordion.tsx`, `sheet.tsx` and `chart.tsx` were styled, exported and imported nowhere; v1.1 deleted all four, and `recharts` went with the chart primitive. The product's only disclosure is the hand-rolled chevron on a file row and its only tab-like control is the sign-in switch — if either pattern recurs, reinstate one primitive and retire the hand-rolled version rather than adding a third. `Chart` in particular should not come back: the charts this product makes are drawn into the deck, not the page. `progress.tsx` and `separator.tsx` survive unused — both are dependency-free, and they are the right thing to reach for instead of hand-rolling a bar or a divider.

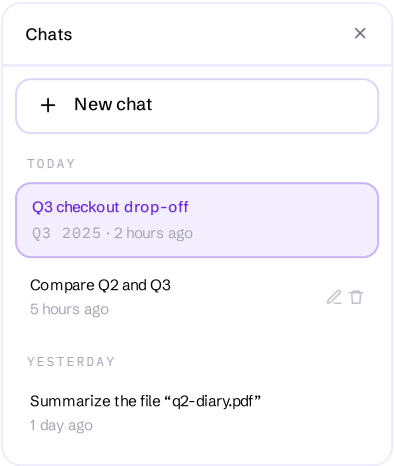
`tabs.tsx`, `accordion.tsx`, `sheet.tsx` and `chart.tsx` are styled and exported but imported nowhere. They are not part of the current design language and should not be treated as precedent. Two consequences: the product's only "accordion" is the hand-rolled chevron disclosure on a file row, and its only tab-like control is the hand-rolled sign-in / create-account switch — if a real need for either arises, adopt the primitive and delete the hand-rolled one rather than adding a third pattern. `chart.tsx` also drags in `recharts`: there is no chart anywhere in the app, because the charts this product makes are drawn in the deck.



Left is identity and history. The drawer toggle sits *before* the wordmark and is a toggle, not an opener — `aria-expanded` tracks it and it takes `bg-muted` while open. Clicking the wordmark starts over: fresh session, back to `/`.

Right is navigation, then environment, then account, separated by 1px rules. The active route is the *filled* nav button; the other two are ghost. There is a single icon that shows the mode you would switch *to*. The avatar is last, and everything anchored to it — menu, panels, toasts — appears below it in that same column.

56px, fixed, z-50, hairline bottom. No shadow: the bar is part of the page, not floating above it. Content clears it with `pt-14`. The bar never contains page-specific controls — those belong to the view.

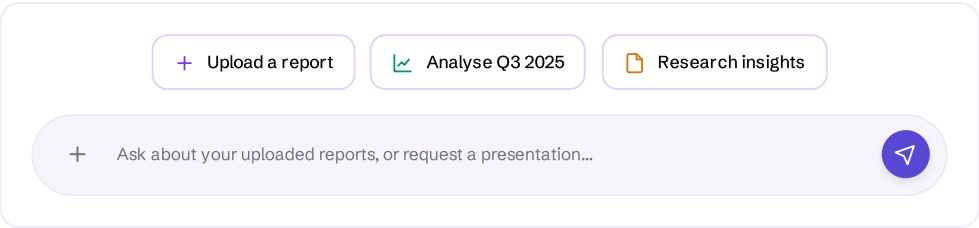


288px, slides from the left over a scrim. The scrim starts below the top bar, so the bar stays reachable. Closing works three ways — the X, the scrim, or Escape.

Grouped by recency, not paginated: Today / Yesterday / This week / Earlier, labelled in mono uppercase. Empty groups are omitted. Sessions with no messages never appear.

Row hierarchy is inverted from the obvious. The primary line is the conversation's own name — a title the user set, else the last message with markdown stripped, else the period. Quarter and relative time are secondary. People recognise what they said, not when they said it.

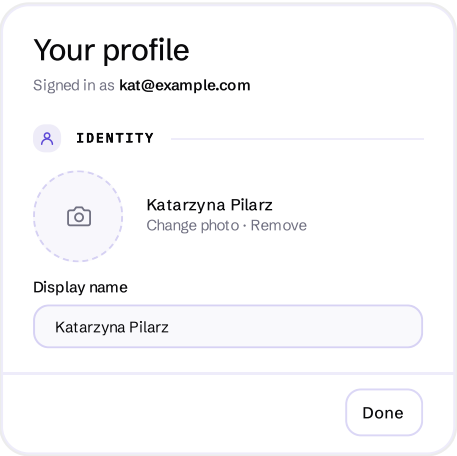
Selected = tint + tinted border (`violet-500/10 + /40`) with violet ink. **Renaming happens in place:** the title becomes a bare input underlined in violet, the metadata line swaps to "Enter to save · Esc to cancel", and the row actions collapse to a single check.



A pill, not a box — `rounded-full`, `bg-muted/50`, backdrop-blurred, fixed to the bottom of the chat column at `max-w-3xl`. It is the one place in the app that uses a full-round container for input, and that is what marks it as the primary surface, `focus-within` lifts the border to violet with a `ring-2 ring-violet-500/20` halo — the ring belongs to the whole pill, never to the bare textarea inside it (which has its ring removed on purpose).

+ on the left, send on the right, both circular. Upload is a ghost Plus; send is a filled circle that drops to 50% opacity when there is nothing to send. Enter sends, Shift+Enter breaks the line.

Quick actions appear only on an empty new session, centred above the pill, staggered in at 50ms intervals. Upload comes first — the app has nothing to say until data exists. Each carries a hue-coded leading icon at 14px on an otherwise neutral outline button — violet for summarising, emerald for generating, amber for comparing. Never red: the danger hue means one thing. Once a conversation has started they are replaced by contextual follow-ups under the newest reply.



They hang from the avatar, not from the middle of the screen. Both panels override `DialogContent`'s centring to `top-16 right-3` and enter with `slide-in-from-top-2`, so the account menu, its panels and every confirmation toast occupy one column in the top-right corner.

Structure: a `text-2xl` title block, a scrollable body of sections, and a flush footer holding the dismissal. Each section opens with the same header — a 24px muted icon tile, a mono uppercase label, and a hairline running to the right edge.

Fields inside a panel take `bg-muted/30` so they read as recessed against the panel's own surface, unlike the transparent fields on a page. `max-h-[calc(100vh-5rem)]` keeps a long panel inside the viewport.

WHERE A CONTROL BELONGS	
SURFACE	WHAT LIVES THERE
Top bar	Identity, route navigation, theme, account. Never anything specific to the current view.
View header	The view's title, its one-line purpose, and its single primary action.
Row / card	Actions that operate on that record, ordered alternative → primary → destructive → disclosure.
Composer	Everything that starts a request: upload, quick actions, the message itself.
Anchored panel	Account and workspace preferences — reversible settings, never decisions.
Centred dialog	Irreversible decisions only.

A control that does not fit one of these six homes is a sign the interaction is wrong, not that a seventh surface is needed. The product has deliberately never grown a toolbar, a context menu, a filter bar or a settings page.

MESSAGE ROWS

Analyse Q3 2025 and compare it with Q2.

14:22:09

+

Q3 2025 at a glance

SUS rose to 78.4, up 4.2 points on Q2 p.2. Task success held flat.

• Checkout abandonment fell 9 points after the address-form change.

Aurelo · Q3 2025

⚡ 3.1s 14:22:14

↳ Generate Q3 2025 presentation

↳ Compare with Q2

+

ⓘ No research data found for Q1 2026. Upload a report for that period to analyse it.

ELEMENT	SPECIFICATION
Assistant mark	32px, radius .md, violet → purple gradient, white Sparkles. The one gradient inside the app surface — it marks generated content, and nothing else may use it.
Bubble radius	14px on three corners, 2px on the corner nearest its author — bottom-left for the assistant, bottom-right for the user
Assistant bubble	bg-muted/50 + hairline · full width of the column
User bubble	solid #23233d / 90 white ink · max-w - [85%], right-aligned · inverts to near-white in dark
Error bubble	border-destructive/30 + bg-destructive/5 + leading alert icon, all in destructive ink
Metadata row	Below the bubble, 12px ink: context tag · ⚡ duration · timestamp. Suppressed when the duration is zero — the app does not report a measurement it does not have
Row rhythm	gap-4 avatar-bubble · space-y-6 between rows

ASSISTANT PROSE — MARKDOWN-MESSAGE.TSX

Model output is normalised before rendering, and the renderer overrides every element so a message can never import foreign typography. Headings step 18 / 16 / 15px semibold; paragraphs are text-sm leading-relaxed; lists drop the native marker for a muted • in a flex row, so every item stacks cleanly; tables get a rounded, bordered scroll container with a bg-muted/70 head; code is a bg-muted/60 chip. Source citations become a violet mono chip (p. 2) with the exact location in its tooltip — never raw (p. 2 ¶2) punctuation. Streaming reveals text behind a blinking violet caret that exists only while streaming.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Processing request

✓ Retrieving data from Sanity CMS...

⦿ Extracting research intelligence...

○ Planning the narrative structure...

1.2s

A ladder, not a spinner. Steps appear one at a time and each carries three simultaneous signals: dot form (hollow → violet pulse → emerald check), text weight (muted → medium → struck through), and, once real timings arrive, a mono duration. The sequence is chosen by query type and names the actual pipeline stage. Never replace this with an indeterminate spinner: the wait is long enough that the user is owed a reason for it.

PRESENTATION CARD

Q3 2025

8 slides · Dossier template

✓ Ready

Download .pptx

Research template

Four states in one card: idle (Generate), generating (the step ladder plus a live mono elapsed counter), ready (thumbnail strip + Download), error (destructive border, the message, and a Retry). The strip is the only place the deck's palette appears in the app — ground #F3F2F2, violet #6D4AF5 — because it is a picture of the deck. Before generation it is labelled a representative strip, not a promise; afterwards it shows what the deck actually contains.

PAGE HEADER — EVERY VIEW OPENS THE SAME WAY

Your Files

Upload research files — the source of everything the assistant knows.

display text-3x1 headline · mb-2 · one muted sentence saying what the view is for · the view's single primary action pinned top-right · mb-8 before content. Do not add breadcrumbs, tabs or filters to this header — there are none in the product.

+ Upload in chat

ROW COLLECTION — FILES-VIEW.TSX

 q3-usability-stud...
PDF · 1.4 MB · 3 days ago

Q3 2025

 Summarize

 Generate presentation





Left to right: identity, facts, evidence, actions, disclosure. A 40px tinted tile carries the type icon; the filename is the primary line; the mono metadata line is extension · size · relative age. Both prompts carry a leading icon — a violet Sparkles on Summarize because it starts an AI action, and Layers on the filled primary — and the delete and chevron are ghost icon buttons, not bare glyphs. The period badges are the row's *evidence* — what this file actually contributed — and they hide below sm. The chevron always sits last and rotates 180° to reveal the stored summary on a bg-muted / 30 shelf inside the same card. Rows are space-y-3 apart and never striped.

METRIC TILES — DASHBOARD.TSX

Total Presentations

12



Slides Generated



Label above, figure below, tinted icon tile to the right. Four across at gap-4. The figure is text-3x1 font-semibold — the only place a number gets display weight. While loading, a tile shows an em dash, never a zero: a zero is a measurement, and the app does not report measurements it does not have yet. Every figure here is computed from the fetched rows; none is stored or estimated.

THE THREE NON-CONTENT STATES

 Loading your files...

LOADING

 No files yet.

Upload research reports from the chat with the + button.

Go to chat

EMPTY

 No research data found for Q1 2026.

ERROR

Loading is always a 16px spinner beside a sentence naming what is loading — never a skeleton, and never a bare spinner. Empty is a 32-40px muted glyph, a plain statement, one line of instruction, and an outline button pointing at the fix. It never fakes content. Error is a rose-tinted block with a leading icon that says what failed in one sentence, plus a retry where retrying is possible.

DESTRUCTIVE FLOW — THE ONLY MULTI-STEP INTERACTION

1 · Offer
Ghost trash icon, red only on hover

→

2 · Name the cost
Centred dialog, red icon tile, exact consequences

→

3 · Commit
Solid red button → “Deleting..”, dialog locked

→

4 · Report
Toast naming what actually went

The description must name the collateral, not just the target. Deleting a file also deletes the research periods only it supplied, so the dialog prints those periods in mono and says what stops working. Deleting a deck says the opposite — the research is untouched and the deck can be regenerated. The toast then reports the real outcome (“Deleted q3-usability.pdf and its Q3 2025 data”), not a generic success. While the action is pending the dialog cannot be dismissed by Escape or the scrim.

SIGN-IN



Sign in to pick up your conversations and presentations.

Sign in

Create account

Email

you@example.com

Password

.....

Sign in

Your research data stays on this machine.

One screen, two explicit modes. Sign-in never auto-registers — a mistyped email must be refused, not answered with an empty workspace that looks like data loss. The mode switch is a segmented control, not tabs. Registration adds an optional avatar drop target (dashed circle, violet on hover) and confirm-password. The closing line states the privacy guarantee, because that is the product's actual promise.

UXPROOF DESIGN SYSTEM

PATTERNS — COLLECTIONS, STATES, DESTRUCTIVE FLOWS

ACTIONS

Emphasis is a budget, not a style choice

Exactly one filled button per view or dialog. Alternatives are outline; chrome is ghost. If a screen seems to need two primaries, it needs two screens — or one of them is not primary.

Destructive actions are confirmed, always, and only once

Every deletion routes through `ConfirmDialog`. There is no `undo` and no “are you sure?” snackbar — the confirmation happens before, not after. Non-destructive actions are never confirmed; the app does not ask permission to do what was just asked of it.

A disabled control owes an explanation

Every `disabled` in the codebase pairs with a `title` saying what is missing. Disabling silently is the one interaction the product treats as a defect.

Expensive work waits for a click

Deck generation auto-starts only for a genuinely fresh reply (under 60s old, not restored from history, not an upload follow-up). Restored conversations never fire background work. An upload offers the deck; it does not start building one.

FEEDBACK

All confirmation is a toast, in one column

Under the avatar, `top-16 right-4`, max 10s, pausable, dismissable. No per-view banners, no inline success text, no alert dialogs for success.

Say what happened, not that something happened

“Deleted q3-usability.pdf and its Q3 2025 data”, not “Deleted successfully”. Where an action has consequences the user did not name, the confirmation names them.

Long work is narrated by stage

Multi-second operations show the named pipeline steps with per-step timings, not a progress bar and not a spinner. Sub-second operations show nothing.

Errors are quiet, specific and local

A failure renders where it happened — an error bubble in the thread, a destructive card state, one `role="alert"` line above a form's submit. Never a modal. Retry is offered wherever retrying could work.

Sign-in failures say one thing

“No such account” and “wrong password” return the same message, by design — the form must not become an account-enumeration oracle. This is a product rule that constrains the UI copy, and it outranks helpfulness.

NAVIGATION & SURFACES

The URL is the source of truth

There is no `currentView` flag. The top bar reads `usePathname()` and pushes routes; the active nav fill is derived from the path. Selecting a session from a non-chat route navigates for real, because the shallow `pushState` the store uses only works while a chat surface is mounted.

The wordmark means “start over”

Clicking it opens a fresh session at `/`. It is not a home link to a marketing page — there isn't one.

Two kinds of modal, chosen by consequence

Anchored under the avatar for settings and profile — reversible, ambient, and visibly connected to the account menu. Screen-centred for confirmations — irreversible, and meant to interrupt. Never anchor a decision; never centre a preference.

Chrome persists; views swap

`AppShell` holds the top bar, drawer, panels and toaster across every route. Pages stay server components rendering a thin `*-view.tsx`; all state and animation live in `components/`. Views enter with a 200ms opacity-and-blur fade — the only route transition in the product.

Theme is explicit, light by default

One toggle in the top bar showing the mode you would move to, persisted to `localStorage`. The OS preference is consulted only on a first visit with nothing stored. Every colour decision must therefore be written as a `light dark: pair`.

HONESTY RULES THAT SHAPE THE UI

Product invariants that decide what may be drawn:

- **Nothing on screen is invented.** Every figure comes from a file the signed-in user uploaded. The interface therefore has no placeholder data, no sample dashboard and no demo mode — an account with no uploads sees an empty state asking for a file.
- **Measurements that were not taken are not shown.** The ⚡ 0.0s case is filtered out of the message metadata rather than printed.
- **A preview is labelled as a preview.** The slide strip stays representative until the deck exists.
- **Deleting data means deleting it.** The UI never hides a record it still keeps, and the confirmation names every downstream thing that goes with it.

KEYBOARD

KEY	BEHAVIOUR
Enter	Sends the message · commits an in-place rename · submits a form
Shift + Enter	Newline in the composer
Escape	Closes the drawer; cancels a rename first if one is open; closes a dialog unless an action is pending
Tab	Reaches every action, including the hover-revealed row controls (focus-within)

The product has **not** been formally evaluated against a WCAG conformance level, and this document makes no such claim. What follows is the set of practices the code already holds to, stated as rules, plus the gaps that a future audit would find first.

PRACTICES ALREADY IN FORCE

AREA	RULE
Visible focus	A 3px ring-ring/50 halo on every control, from the shared cva base. outline-none is only ever used alongside a replacement ring — never alone.
Semantic controls	Everything clickable is a <button>, an <a> or a Radix primitive. Where a row needs its own actions, they are absolutely-positioned <i>siblings</i> of the row button, never nested buttons.
Names for icon-only controls	Every icon button carries an aria-label; the dialog close additionally ships an sr-only label. Tooltips supplement the name, they never replace it.
State exposed	aria-expanded on the drawer toggle and disclosures · aria-current on the active session · aria-selected + role="tab" on the sign-in switch · aria-invalid driving the error styling.
Live regions	Toasts are role="status" · aria-live="polite"; form errors are role="alert".
Form labelling	Every field has a real <Label htmlFor> and a correct autoComplete; placeholders are examples only.
Keyboard reach	Hover-revealed row actions are also revealed by focus-within, so nothing is mouse-only.
Decoration hidden	All illustrative SVG is aria-hidden; the avatar preview uses an empty alt when the name is already adjacent.
Reduced motion	A global CSS override plus MotionConfig · reducedMotion="user". No animation is the sole carrier of meaning.
Text size	Fields render at 16px below md to prevent focus zoom; body text is 14px, metadata 12px, and nothing that must be read is below 10px.

COLOUR AND CONTRAST

Measured ratios are on page 04. As of v1.1 every text pair in the palette clears 4.5:1 in both themes — two values moved to get there, and the two that remain below it (emerald and amber) are icon-only by rule. Treat muted-foreground-on-card (5.06:1) as the floor. Separately: colour is **never** the only signal. Pipeline steps also change dot shape and text decoration; toasts also carry a distinct icon; the active nav item is a fill change, not a hue change.

KNOWN GAPS — FIX THESE BEFORE CLAIMING CONFORMANCE

1 • Touch targets are below the 44×44 guidance

Icon buttons are 24–32px and row actions 24px. Acceptable for a pointer-driven desktop tool, and consistent with the product's density — but it is a real gap, and it is the reason no mobile layout should be “added” without revisiting control sizing.

2 • title is doing explanatory work

Disabled controls explain themselves through the native title attribute, which is inconsistently exposed by assistive technology and unavailable to keyboard users. The explanation should move into visible helper text or an aria-describedby target.

3 • The sign-in switch is a partial tab implementation

It has role="tablist", role="tab" and aria-selected, but no tabpanel, no aria-controls and no arrow-key navigation. Complete it — or drop the tab roles for aria-pressed toggles, which is closer to what it actually is. (The Tabs primitive was deleted as dead code in v1.1.)

4 • Streaming text is not announced

Assistant replies reveal character by character with no live region, so a screen reader gets no notification that an answer has arrived. A aria-live="polite" region announcing the completed message is the minimal fix.

5 • Emerald/amber are one careless label away from failing

Confined to icons, which clear the 3:1 graphics threshold. v1.1 deleted the one place they were paired with text — an unrendered feature list in welcome-empty-state.tsx. Guard this in review; the rule is in CLAUDE.md.

6 • No skip link past the fixed chrome

Keyboard users traverse the top bar on every route. A skip-to-content link is cheap and currently absent.

CHECKLIST FOR ANY NEW COMPONENT

- ☐ Reachable and operable by keyboard alone, in a sensible order
- ☐ Focus is visible using the standard ring — not a custom one, and never removed
- ☐ It is a real control element, or a Radix primitive; no clickable div
- ☐ Icon-only? It has an aria-label
- ☐ Stateful? The state is in the DOM (aria-expanded / -current / -selected / -invalid)
- ☐ Colour is not the only difference between two states
- ☐ Text meets the contrast floor on the surface it actually sits on — check against card, not background
- ☐ Danger uses destructive, never a raw red-* or rose-*
- ☐ Any animation is suppressed under prefers-reduced-motion
- ☐ Anything announced asynchronously sits in a live region
- ☐ Disabled? The reason is visible, not only in a title

SEMANTIC TOKEN MAP

Machine-readable form: `context/design-system/design-tokens.json`. The `source` column there names the CSS custom property or Tailwind utility that actually ships — this map is a naming layer over the implementation, not a replacement for it.

TOKEN	LIGHT	DARK
color.background.default	#ffffff	#13131f
color.surface.default · overlay	#f8f7fc	#171726
color.surface.sunken	#eefcf8	#21213a
color.text.primary	#09090b	#eeef5
color.text.secondary	#696979	#9090b0
color.text.inverse	#ffffff	#13131f
color.border.default	rgba(91,71,214,.10)	rgba(120,100,220,.13)
color.action.primary · #fff on	#5B47D6	#7060e0
color.action.secondary	#f0effe	#21213a
color.accent.ink	#7c3aed	#a78bfa
color.accent.wash	violet-500/10	violet-500/10
color.focus.ring	#5B47D6 @ 50%	#7060e0 @ 50%
color.status.success icon	#059669	#34d399
color.status.progress	#8b5cf6	#a78bfa
color.status.advisory icon	#d97706	#fbbf24
color.status.error	#d4183d	#f87171
color.status.onError	#ffffff	#13131f
typography.family.sans	Schibsted Grotesk → "Helvetica Neue", sans-serif	
typography.family.mono	IBM Plex Mono → monospace	
typography.display	30px / 600 / -0.04em / 1.05	
typography.body	14px / 400 / 1.625	
typography.meta	12px / 400 / 1.5	
spacing.xs ... 3xl	4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32	
radius.sm / md / lg / xl / full	6 · 8 · 10 · 14 · 9999	
border.width.hairline	1px — the only width in the app	
shadow.sm / md / lg	card lift · floating menu · toast	
layout.topbar.height	56px	
layout.drawer.width	288px	
layout.content.chat / files / decks	768 · 896 · 1280px	
motion.duration.fast / base / slow	100 · 200 · 300ms	
motion.easing.enter	cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)	

V1.0 FINDINGS — RESOLVED IN THE CODE

v1.0 of this document catalogued eight inconsistencies in the shipped system. Six are now fixed in code rather than described; two remain open and are stated as rules.

✓ Three reds became one token

Every `red-*` and `rose-*` utility is gone. Validation, error bubbles, error toasts, delete affordances and the confirm button all read `--destructive / --destructive-foreground`, with `/5-/20` washes. The dark pair was inverted on the way through — it scored 2.66:1 and made form errors almost invisible.

✓ Eleven dead tokens deleted

All eight `--sidebar-*` tokens plus `--input-background` and `--switch-background`, in both themes, along with the `--color-sidebar-*` mappings in `@theme inline`. The drawer is not a separately-themed surface, and a second surface palette would fracture the system.

✓ Seven dead files deleted

Three product components — `presentation-download-button.tsx` (painted in a zinc/emerald palette belonging to neither theme), `ai-processing-state.tsx`, `pipeline-status.tsx` — and four unused primitives (tabs, accordion, sheet, chart). `recharts` went with the chart primitive; removing it also surfaced `immer` as an undeclared direct dependency of the store, now declared.

✓ The primary button hovers

Its hover rule was scoped to `[a]`, so a real `<button>` never responded. Fixed in the `cva` recipe — and the two per-call-site overrides that existed to paper over it were deleted, which is the general rule: fix the recipe, never the call site.

✓ Contrast raised to AA throughout

`--muted-foreground` darkened from `#717182` to `#696979`, clearing 4.5:1 on background, card and muted alike. The only pairs still under it are emerald and amber, which are icon-only by rule — and the one place they were paired with a text label, an unrendered feature list, is gone.

◆ Dashboard gradients — scoped exception

The eight hashed multi-hue gradients stay; they give each deck a stable, recognisable cover in a grid of otherwise identical cards, and the hue carries no meaning. The exception is now written at the definition in `dashboard.tsx` and in `CLAUDE.md` — decorative cover for a generated artefact only, never chrome, status, data or type.

○ Still open — two heading systems

The base layer styles bare `h1/h2/h3`, but every page headline sets `display text-3xl` explicitly, so the base rule almost never applies. Treat the base layer as a safety net for markdown-ish content and always set the role explicitly in components.

○ Still open — duplicated password field

The same `PasswordInput` is defined in `login-screen.tsx` and `profile-dialog.tsx`, differing only by a `bg-muted/30`. One component in `components/ui/`, with the panel fill as a prop.